

M E R N Empathy Map Canvas

shopEZ — B2C E-Commerce Marketplace (MERN Stack)

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Empathy Map Canvas

1. Introduction

This document presents the Empathy Map Canvas for the two primary user personas of the ShopEZ platform. Empathy mapping is a collaborative design-thinking tool used to articulate a deep understanding of the target users' mental models, motivations, pain points, and desired gains — ensuring that design and development decisions remain grounded in genuine user needs rather than assumptions.

Two distinct personas have been profiled: the Convenience-Seeking Shopper (B2C end-consumer) and the Operationally-Stretched Store Administrator (B2B operator). Each persona is analysed across six dimensions: Think & Feel, Hear, See, Say & Do, Pains, and Gains.

2. Persona 1 — "The Convenience-Seeking

Shopper"

PERSONA 1

Name: The Convenience-Seeking Shopper

Profile: Urban professional, 24–40 years of age, technologically proficient.

Shops online 3–6 times per month across devices (mobile and desktop). Values speed, security, and a frictionless purchasing experience above all else.

2.1 Empathy Map — Quadrant Chart

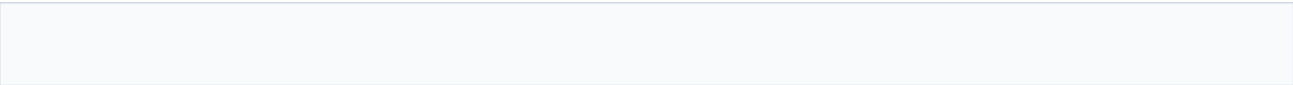


FIGURE 1.1 — EMPATHY MAP QUADRANT CHART: PERSONA 1 —

THE CONVENIENCE-SEEKING SHOPPER

SAY & DO (NEGATIVE)	SAY & DO (POSITIVE)
THINK & FEEL (NEGATIVE)	THINK & FEEL (POSITIVE)

External (Say / Do)

Internal (Think / Feel)

Negative

Experience

Positive

Experience

Filters by price & rating

Saves cart for later

Reads reviews first

Abandons cart (many steps)

Cannot find product category

Anxious about hidden fees

Worried about card safety

Frustrated by slow loading

Feels secure with payments

Expects fast search

2.2 Detailed Dimension Analysis

Ø>Ýà THINK & FEEL

"I hope this website is genuinely
secure with my credit card
information."

"I need to find what I'm looking
for within the first two minutes
— otherwise, I'm leaving."

Experiences anxiety regarding
undisclosed shipping fees at the
final checkout step.

Feels relief and purchase
confidence when product
pages feature high-resolution
images, verified reviews, and
clear stock indicators.

Ø=ÜB HEAR

"You should try this platform —
it delivered within 48 hours
and the return process was
effortless."

"Always check the reviews before
committing to a purchase."

"Is the payment integration
secure? Did they verify with a
gateway?"

Peer recommendations heavily
influence first-time platform
adoption decisions.

Ø=ÜA SEE

Competitor platforms with
cluttered, information-dense

product listing pages.

Retargeted advertisements

across social media for

previously-viewed items.

Clean, modern, mobile-first

interfaces on market-leading e-

commerce platforms.

Inconsistent typography and

layout on less-polished

competitor sites.

Ø=ÿã SAY & DO

"I'll add this to my cart and

complete the purchase on my

laptop later tonight."

"I cannot locate the exact

category I need — the

navigation is confusing."

Frequently abandons checkout

flow when it requires more

than three steps.

Habitually applies price and

rating filters before browsing

product listings.

Reads a minimum of five

reviews before purchasing

above 1500.

Ø=þ# PAINS

Significant loading delays on

product listing and image-

heavy pages.

Loss of cart items upon session

expiry or when switching

between devices.

Unnecessarily complicated

return/refund and order-

tracking procedures.

Unexpected charges appearing

at the final step of checkout.

Ø=P GAINS

Time saved through a

streamlined, guided checkout

(Address !' Payment !'

Confirm).

Peace of mind from a trusted,

recognisable payment gateway

integration.

High satisfaction when the

search and filter system surfaces

exactly what is needed within

seconds.

3. Persona 2 — "The Operationally-Stretched

Store Administrator"

PERSONA 2

Name: The Operationally-Stretched Store Administrator

Profile: Small-to-medium business owner, 30–50 years of age, moderate technical proficiency. Manages day-to-day store operations including inventory, pricing, and customer order fulfilment. Time-constrained and seeking efficiency over advanced configuration.

3.1 Detailed Dimension Analysis

Ø>Ýà THINK & FEEL

"I need to know, at a glance,
how much revenue was
generated this month versus
last."

"Updating product images takes
far too long — I need a faster
image upload process."

Feels overwhelmed when order
status updates require
navigating multiple
disconnected screens.

Concerned about stock
accuracy — fears overselling
when checkout and inventory
are not synchronised in real-
time.

Ø=ÜB HEAR

"You need a dashboard that
shows your numbers clearly —
not buried in spreadsheets."

"Customers are complaining

that product images are low quality and take ages to load."

"You should be able to add a product listing in under two minutes."

Ø=ÜA SEE

Competitors using integrated admin panels with real-time analytics widgets.

Their own sales data trapped in manual, error-prone spreadsheet exports.

E-commerce SaaS platforms with high monthly subscription costs.

Ø=Ýã SAY & DO

"Every time I upload a new product, I need to manually resize and host the images."

"I have no way to see which products are underperforming."

Spends disproportionate time on repetitive admin tasks that should be automated.

Delays fulfilling orders because the order list interface is difficult to parse.

Ø=Þ# PAINS

No centralised dashboard presenting aggregated sales metrics and order statuses.

Image management is a

significant operational

bottleneck without CDN

support.

Inability to quickly identify

low-stock items before they go

out of stock.

Ø=P GAINS

A dedicated, secure /admin

panel with role-protected

access.

Cloudinary-powered image

uploads that auto-optimise and

serve via CDN.

Sales analytics (monthly

revenue charts, order volume

trends) at a glance.

One-click order status updates

(Processing !' Shipped !'

Delivered).

4. Persona Comparison Summary

Dimension	Persona 1 — B2C Shopper	Persona 2 — Store Administrator
Primary Goal	Find and purchase products quickly and securely	Manage inventory and monitor business performance efficiently
Core Pain	Cart loss, slow site, confusing checkout	No analytics dashboard, manual image handling
Core Gain	Streamlined checkout, trusted payment gateway	Cloudinary CDN, real-time sales metrics
Platform Feature Needed	Search & Filter, Persistent Cart, 3-step Checkout	Admin Panel, Cloudinary Upload, Revenue Charts
Tech Enabler	React SPA + MongoDB Cart + Stripe/Razorpay	Node.js Admin API + Cloudinary + MongoDB Aggregation

5. Conclusion

The empathy maps for both personas reveal a shared underlying theme: the demand for speed, trust, and operational efficiency. The B2C Shopper requires a fast, transparent, and secure purchasing experience. The Store Administrator requires a centralised, automated operations platform. Both sets of needs are systematically addressed by the ShopEZ feature set, as validated in the Problem–Solution Fit and Requirement Analysis documents. Every platform feature should be evaluated against its contribution to resolving at least one documented Pain or enabling at least one documented Gain for these two primary personas.
